

State of Open Source: Trends, Insights and Lessons

The open source world is in a state of constant evolution, with new trends emerging continuously at a pretty quick pace. Here's a summary of what has been happening in the recent past in this world, and especially at GitHub, to help developers analyse what the future holds.



source community last year. This has allowed it to continue to build software and pass it across the world. In 2021, there were more than three million people who were contributing to open source projects for the first time, and this number only seems to be growing. Good mentorship can really help these first time contributors and is an important community asset. When new contributors get friendly and timely reviews, and there is a commitment to mentorship from the team, there is a positive effect on productivity.

A healthy, collaborative and strong culture can actually reduce the need for mentorship itself. People who are interested in open source can get involved through special interest groups, not just deep technical communities. If you look (refer to Figure 1) at the percentage of contributors who have opened an account over the past two years, you can see a lot of repositories that are getting developers started with their open source journey. The topics in these repositories include gaming, manga, science education, and much more. Developers tend to first contribute in these areas and then move on to the deep technical community.

Documentation

Documentation is key to getting any developer or open source contributor started. Regardless of the format, documentation is important. Building on top of someone else's work in a community can help accelerate one's growth. Documentation also often

GitHub, as we all know, is a code hosting platform where the world builds software. Over 83 million developers and more than four million organisations are using it today. The open source ecosystem itself is seeing more than 2.6 billion contributions per year, thousands of open source communities, and more than 200 million private and public repositories. So, essentially, this is where a lot of the activity around open source development is happening today. Just last year, over 16 million new users joined the platform. About 61 million new repositories and 170 million pull requests also got merged.

India is witnessing a lot of open source contributions as well as development in this space. There are more than 8 million users of GitHub in the country. Over 200 million contributions to open source came from India in the last year alone. It is also important to note that more than 10 million software projects around the world depend on packages that were created in India.

Let us now talk about communities, documentation, and about developer experience along with the latest trends.

Communities

GitHub welcomed more than 1.4 million new contributors to the open